

conspicuous imbalance in the number seats in the Diet, and aim to realize clean politics that does not cost money.

JAPAN COMMUNIST PARTY (JCP)

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1. Diplomacy and Defense

Even after the restoration of Japan-China relations, Japan continues to be a base for the invasion of Vietnam. The United States' "power policy" remains unchanged, the cold war structure remains in place, and the security treaty still remains in force. We will stop the government's complicity in the American invasion of Vietnam and demand the immediate signing of a peace agreement. In order to truly bring an end to the postwar period, we will normalize relations with Vietnam and Korea, plus strive to conclude a Japan-Soviet peace treaty and bring a settlement to the Kurile Islands issue. In particular, we have a pressing need to abrogate the Security Treaty and make Japan independent, peaceful, and neutral. We oppose the Fourth Five-Year Defense Plan, which will strengthen the offensive military capability. We will stop Japan's dependence on the U.S. and disband the constitutionally illegal Self-Defense Forces. Under the present Constitution, Japan cannot have military troops, and we will seek the will of the people in deciding the future of the Self-Defense Forces. We aim to establish a true collective security system in Asia.

2. Restructuring the Country

We oppose the big capitalists' "Restructuring the Japanese Archipelago Plan," which will spread pollution throughout the country, and, instead, we will push for a plan for nation-building that is based on the people, built on plans from below. We will give precedence to policies dealing with overcrowding and the building of housing, sewage systems, and other basic needs of life, and we will prevent disasters and protect the environment. We will close the gap between urban and rural areas through the balanced development of industry and transportation. Part of the expenses will be borne by large corporations, thus reducing the burden of the residents. We will stabilize prices as well as assure the availability of sites by restricting land speculation by big business, expropriating at fair prices the sites that were bought up, and opening up public land and the land used by military bases. We will strengthen controls over the total discharge of wastes by revising the pollution laws, make clear the responsibility of corporations and prevent discharge at its source, strengthen supervision by creating a pollution committee whose members are elected publicly, and also control pollution from military bases.

3. National Life

The key to improving national life lies in the controlling the tyranny of the big capitalists. Prices: We will establish a committee in the Diet and lower the prices of monopolies. We

will reverse the setup where public utility charges are cheap for big capitalists but expensive for the public. We will stabilize food prices through lifetime contracts and shipping contracts. We will suspend the national debt that has swelled to wartime levels and hold down inflation. Taxes: We will end special rights given to big capitalists in the form of lower taxes and tax exemptions and carry out a 2 trillion yen tax cut for the masses. We will allow up to 1.5 million yen for a family of four in tax exemptions for the three taxes of income, residence, and business.

4. Social Welfare

We oppose the policy of giving preference to large corporations and providing a low level of welfare at high expense and we will increase the expenditures on pensions, medical care, and other social security services by the country and the big capitalists. We will change the pension system currently based on the reserve fund method to one based on the levy system, and we will raise the various types pensions for couples to at least 60 thousand yen and per person welfare pensions to 30 thousand yen. We will make medical care free for the aged, infants, those afflicted with incurable diseases, and handicapped children. We will make the ratio of labor and management contributions to health insurance 3 to 7, respectively, and we will provide benefits to 10 percent of the principal beneficiaries and 80 percent of the families and national health insurance to 90 percent

of the principal beneficiaries and families. We will expand welfare facilities for mothers and children and for handicapped children.

5. Political Position

Fifty years of indomitability, from prewar through postwar, and carrying through national sovereignty, democracy, and opposition to the war of aggression, we are the true reformist party that will protect our sovereign independence. We are the only clean party, not having received any contributions from the economic world and having confronted the big capitalists of Japan and U.S. We aim for socialism without war and exploitation, and we will immediately form a united reformist front and build an independent and democratic Japan by fostering a government based on a democratic alliance. We will allow political donations only by individuals and forbid donations by companies and groups, and we will eradicate the politics of money and corruption. We will correct the number of seats so that the Diet truly reflects the will of the people.